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Student Registration Number	252U1R7098	**Class &Section: CSE(FSD) 309 1B**
Study Level: UG/PG	UG	**Year &Term: 1ST** & 1ST
Subject Name	Fundamentals Of Web Development	

Name of the Assessment	Reflective Journal - 1
Date of Submission	17/11/2025

Reflective Journal Template

Journal Entry Guidelines	**Description**
1. Experience (Class Content)	Briefly describe the topics or concepts discussed during the class.
2. Feelings (Emotional Reactions)	Share your emotional reactions and thoughts during the class. How did you feel while learning this theory? Did the class evoke specific emotions or questions?
3. Learning (Key Insights)	Reflect on what you learned from the class. Highlight the key insights or fundamental concepts you gained from the class.
4. Application (Practical Use)	Describe how you plan to apply the theory you've learned in real-life situations or in your academic/career endeavours. Explain the practical utility of this theory.

Sample Journal Entry

Date	
Journal Entry Topic	**Introduction to HTML and CSS**

1. Experience (Class Content)	The recent "Introduction to HTML and CSS" class was an eye-opener, providing a foundational look into real-world website construction. We began with **HTML (Hyper Text Markup Language)**, which the instructor clarified is a markup, not a programming, language essential for organizing and structuring webpage content. The class emphasized the basic skeleton of a webpage, starting with the core tags: <html>, <head>, and <body>, each serving a distinct layout purpose. We explored the structural tags, including heading tags (<h1> to <h6>) for indicating content importance and the <p> tag for standard paragraphs. The <a> (anchor) tag, which creates hyperlinks and connects pages across the web, was particularly fascinating, demonstrating how simple tags form the digital backbone of the internet. Following HTML, we moved to the more exciting realm of **CSS (Cascading Style Sheets)**, which is responsible for transforming plain HTML into visually appealing designs. The three methods of applying CSS (inline, internal, and external) were explained, with external CSS being highlighted as the preferred method for multi-page projects. We learned the fundamental syntax of selectors, properties, and values for controlling styles such as colors, fonts, background, borders, margins, and padding. The hands-on session involved practically applying CSS properties to sample HTML files, which made concepts like adjusting text alignment and experimenting with layouts highly enjoyable. A key takeaway was the **box model**, which defines how an element's total space is calculated by combining its content, padding, border, and margin. This concept underscored that web design is as much about structure and spacing as it is about visual appearance. The instructor also introduced the use of color codes in hexadecimal and RGB formats for precise color selection. The entire session concluded by reinforcing that HTML (for structure) and CSS (for styling) together form the essential foundation of front-end web development. This realization cemented the class as the crucial first step toward becoming a full web developer.

	Overall, the session provided a strong, clear understanding of how websites are built from scratch, explaining how structural and design decisions impact both function and look. This foundation has sparked excitement for tackling more advanced topics like JavaScript and responsive design in the future.
2. Feelings (Emotional Reactions)	At the start of the class, I walked in with a mixture of curiosity and a slight nervousness, because although I had seen countless websites before, I had never understood what actually goes on behind them. The idea of learning how to make a webpage felt both exciting and a bit intimidating. But as soon as the teacher introduced HTML, that nervousness slowly faded. Hearing that simple tags like <h1> for headings and <p> for paragraphs could shape the entire structure of a webpage surprised me. It felt almost magical that typing a few words inside angled brackets could produce something instantly visible on the screen. When I typed my first few lines of HTML and refreshed the browser to see them appear properly, it gave me a sense of accomplishment that I didn't expect. Once we transitioned to CSS, the class became even more interesting for me. HTML felt like building the skeleton of a webpage, but CSS felt like giving it personality. Changing colours, adjusting fonts, and experimenting with backgrounds made me feel like I was designing something with my own style. I found myself trying out different combinations just to see how they would look, even beyond what the instructor asked. It was fun to watch how one small change in CSS could completely transform the appearance of the page. At the same time, there were points where I felt a little confused—especially when the teacher explained the box model. Understanding how content, padding, borders, and margins all work together felt tricky at first. But once the concept clicked in my mind, I started noticing how important these details are for proper layout and spacing. Emotionally, the session was a blend of excitement, curiosity, and a healthy challenge. I often found myself imagining how experienced developers design entire websites and how they manage to organize everything so

	neatly. I even started wondering about tools like CSS frameworks and how they can make designing faster and more efficient. What made the class even more enjoyable was the environment—everyone was trying things out, making mistakes, and helping each other. We laughed over simple errors like forgetting closing tags or mixing up curly braces, and those small moments made the learning process feel friendly and encouraging. By the time the class ended, I felt genuinely proud of myself. I had not only understood something new but also applied it right away and seen the results instantly on the browser. It felt practical, creative, and rewarding all at once. The session left me motivated to explore web development further, and I even felt inspired to try building a small webpage on my own. Overall, the experience filled me with confidence and a strong desire to learn more, marking the beginning of my journey into the world of designing and developing websites.
3. Learning (Key Insights)	This session on Introduction to HTML and CSS turned out to be far more eye-opening than I expected. Until now, I had only interacted with websites as a regular user, never really thinking about what goes on behind the screen. But this class pulled back the curtain and showed me the actual building blocks that make a webpage come to life. The most surprising part was realising how much of a website's structure depends on simple HTML elements. Instead of being some complicated programming language, HTML felt more like a set of instructions that tell the browser what each part of the page means. Tags like headings, paragraphs, links, and images suddenly made sense once I saw how they work together to form the outline of a webpage. It was interesting to learn that even small details—like writing attributes inside a tag or keeping elements properly nested—make a big difference in how clean and error-free the code turns out. As the lesson moved toward CSS, the whole picture became even clearer. If HTML is the skeleton, then CSS is definitely the design layer that gives a page its look and feel. Understanding selectors and how they target specific parts of the HTML made styling feel logical and organised. It

	amazed me that the same plain page could turn bright, elegant, minimal, or colourful just by changing a few CSS rules. Learning about the three different ways to apply CSS—inline, internal, and external—helped me understand why professional developers rely mostly on external stylesheets. It keeps everything neat and allows multiple pages to share the same design, which is something I had never considered before. The box model was another idea that stood out to me. Before this class, I didn't realise how much thought goes into spacing—padding, margins, borders—and how they influence the overall layout. Once the instructor broke it down visually, it felt much easier to understand how elements sit on the page and how small adjustments can shift entire sections. The discussion on colour formats like hex codes and RGB values also opened my eyes to how precise web design can be. Instead of just selecting a random colour, developers can fine-tune shades with exact values. I also appreciated learning about semantic HTML tags such as <header>, <nav>, and <section>. It showed me that building a webpage isn't only about making it look good—it's also about making it meaningful for search engines, screen readers, and accessibility tools. This deeper purpose behind code gave me a new respect for proper web structure. By the end of the class, I realised that web development is a blend of logic, creativity, structure, and design. Writing the practical code exercises helped everything click, because each change I made became visible instantly in the browser. Seeing the results right away made the entire learning experience more engaging. This session gave me a solid starting point, not just in creating simple webpages but in understanding why HTML and CSS need to work together. It also left me excited to dive into more advanced concepts like responsive layouts, media queries, and modern frameworks as I continue learning.
4. Application (Practical Use)	Learning HTML and CSS has opened up a wide range of practical opportunities for me, both as a student and as someone who hopes to grow into a capable web developer. Now that I understand how webpages are built and styled, I feel confident about creating simple projects on my own. One of my first goals is to design a personal website where I can showcase

	my work—things like class assignments, small coding experiments, and later on, more advanced projects. Building this site will give me a chance to apply everything I've learned, from organising content with HTML to using CSS to create a clean and attractive layout. These skills are valuable far beyond classroom assignments. Today, every business, institution, or individual needs some kind of online presence, and being able to build or maintain a website is an ability that is useful in almost any field. As I progress in my course, having a strong grounding in HTML and CSS will also make the transition to more advanced web technologies much smoother. Whether it's JavaScript, React, or back-end frameworks, knowing how the front end works will help me understand how everything fits together. I can already see how helpful this knowledge will be when we begin larger team projects. Understanding how to structure pages properly and style them neatly will allow me to collaborate better with classmates, especially when building full web applications. Once I learn responsive design, I'll be able to adapt layouts for phones, tablets, and desktops using CSS media queries—a skill that is essential in today's multi-device world. Outside of academics, I hope to use what I've learned to take on small freelance tasks or contribute to open-source projects. Even simple jobs like designing landing pages or improving the layout of existing sites can give me real experience and help strengthen my portfolio. This will be especially useful when applying for internships, where practical skills often speak louder than theoretical knowledge. The class also made me more aware of good coding habits. Writing neat HTML, following semantic structure, and keeping CSS organised are skills that will help me not just in web development but in all areas of programming. I've also become more conscious of accessibility—using elements correctly so that websites can be used by people with disabilities. This is something I want to prioritise in future projects because inclusive design is becoming increasingly important. Looking ahead, I know these skills will be beneficial no matter which area of tech I eventually specialise in. Whether I end up focusing on UI/UX design, full-stack development, or even launching a personal brand, having

	the ability to build my own website gives me independence and flexibility. In the long run, HTML and CSS aren't just tools—they're the starting point for creating meaningful online experiences that can reach people across the world.
5.Conclusion	In summary, this Introduction to HTML and CSS class gave me a solid starting point in understanding how websites are built from the ground up. It showed me how the structure created with HTML and the design added through CSS work hand in hand to form webpages that are both useful and attractive. The session not only strengthened my technical basics but also encouraged me to think creatively about design and layout. More importantly, it motivated me to learn more about modern web tools and deeper front-end concepts as I continue my studies and prepare for future opportunities in the tech field.